sincerity, loyalty, team work, managing and negotiation in the apparel industry. Customer satisfaction and retention mainly depends on effective and efficient merchandising.

Function of Merchandisers

- Execution of sample orders
- Costing
- Programming
- Yarn procurement
- Production scheduling or route card drafting
- Accessories arrangement (order placing follow up).
- Approval of various processor's sewing operations
- Pattern approval or dummy size set approval
- Size set approval
- Pre productions follow up
- Pilot run inspection
- In process inspection
- Production controlling
- Identifying shortages & make arrangement to overcome the shortages
- Following quality control procedures
- Following quality assurance procedures
- Monitoring all the activities of in house & sub-contractors unit
- Buyer communication
- Communication with production unit processing units & other 3rd parties (vendors)
- Proper reporting
- Highlighting to the management
- Record maintenance
- Developing samples
- Placement of orders
- Taking measures for consistent production
- Taking preventive action to maintain the targeted performance
- Level in all areas of merchandising
- Attending meeting with superiors & furnishing the required details about merchandising

12.4 Process Flow in a Garment Industry

Garment manufacturing includes a number of processes from order receiving to dispatching and shipment of the finished garments.

12.4.1 Merchandising Department

Merchandiser is a person who interacts with the buyer and seller, and also puts efforts into proper relation between buying offices, buying agents, agency and seller, exporter in terms of executing an order. A garment export unit generally has many departments like stores, cutting, production, packing and checking. Merchandising department is the star of the department among all the working departments in the export concern, because merchandising is the only department having maximum control over the departments and totally responsible for profit and loss of the company. The job of a merchandiser is to coordinate with the entire department in the office as well as the customers. Merchandiser meets the buyers and collects the details of their requirements to develop the relationship with the customer. After conformation of an order from the buyer the planning process for execution of the order is done.

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